

LAB WORKSHEET

Lab 23 — OS and Application Hardening

Name		Date	
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Objective: 3.5 — Server hardening: OS, application, host and hardware hardening; patching workflow.

Work through the lab on the Killercoda Ubuntu playground and record your results below.

Task 1 — Baseline scan

Run Lynis and record the hardening index.

Record the starting index.

Task 2 — Minimise

Disable unused services, close ports, purge packages.

List two services disabled and two packages purged.

Task 3 — App hardening

Apply the nginx hardening headers.

Paste nginx -t result.

Task 4 — HIDS + MAC

Build the AIDE baseline and check AppArmor status.

Confirm AIDE reports no changes post-baseline.

Task 5 — Re-scan

Re-run Lynis.

Record the new index vs. the start.

Completion checklist

- Ran the Lynis scan-fix-rescan loop and improved the index.
- Minimised services, ports and packages.
- Applied application hardening to nginx.
- Established AIDE integrity baseline and a MAC profile.
- Completed the hardware-hardening checklist.